Proposed first 90 days Plan

Introduction

Based on the first interview with Anne Baker and Scott Alter on 2nd October 2026, and the second interview with Anne Baker, Helen Grieger and Jennifer May on 13th October 2026, this document outlines the proposed work and onboarding plan for the first 90 days in the role of CRM Technical Solution Lead.

This document summarises the understanding gained from both interviews and includes several assumptions to support measurable actions.

Gathered Information and Assumptions

The following table describes the information gathered from the interviews as a means of providing context for the objectives and proposed actions.

Type	Gathered Information
Fact	MAB currently uses Viseo as its service provider for customisations and complex projects within the Salesforce ecosystem. MAB management intends to terminate this relationship; however, there is no firm timeline for the disengagement.
Assumption	MAB currently uses Nest for cybersecurity, but the scope of this service and how it is implemented are unclear.
Fact	MAB has used Salesforce for the past 15 years. The current development landscape includes a Salesforce Core production environment and testing and development sandboxes; whether these are full or partial copies is to be confirmed. Salesforce Marketing Cloud is also installed with a single Business Unit, where changes are applied directly in production. Most email automations are one-off emails, but the proportion of journeys remains to be determined.
Fact	Salesforce Marketing Cloud Engagement currently uses Marketing Cloud Connect to interact with Salesforce, providing access to all objects available to the connection user.
Fact	SMS capability is currently installed but underutilised. There is a desire to expand this capability, which will require the team to develop additional skills.
Fact	The deployment pipeline is ad hoc and uses change sets. There was no mention of a cybersecurity platform that analyses potential vulnerabilities in changes deployed to production.
Fact	There is a range of web pages corresponding to different MAB projects which interact directly with Salesforce.
Fact	Knowledge of Salesforce Core and Salesforce Marketing Cloud is currently concentrated among two people who understand the business and can perform administration and testing tasks: Helen Grieger and Jennifer May.
Fact	Different General Managers at MAB currently define the business requirements that lead to Salesforce customisations and new one-off emails or journeys in Marketing Cloud.
Fact	There are existing concerns about the ability to create new or modify current content blocks using HTML5 or AMPscript.
Assumption	A ticketing system was mentioned, but it is unclear which tool is used, such as Jira or Asana.
Assumption	Changes are documented on a platform such as Confluence or SharePoint.
Assumption	IT currently provides a Git-based version-control platform, such as Git or Bitbucket.

Objectives

Human and engagement: build trust and shared ownership

1. Learn about the business by understanding how it operates and how different stakeholders interact with Salesforce. This can be achieved through daily guidance from Helen and Jennifer, participation in brief and purposeful agile ceremonies, and shadowing them during requirements gathering and stakeholder introductions.
2. Build relationships by listening to colleagues' current technical challenges and, where appropriate, suggesting alternatives to improve their processes.
3. Develop the team's skills by sharing our strengths and using Salesforce Trailhead and other learning platforms.
4. Seek continuous feedback from peers and managers, adjust the approach as needed, and identify specific areas for improvement and follow-up actions.

Security: protect customers and the company

1. Protect personal identification information (PII) in testing environments by preventing unmasked copies and masking test data after every refresh.
2. Review who can view and modify data, how the property web pages collect it, and how the systems are connected.
3. Secure the SMS capability while it is unused and maintain backups of Marketing Cloud metadata.
4. Establish basic data governance by maintaining a register that identifies where data is stored and who owns it.

Technical capabilities: make delivery safe, repeatable and in-house

1. Create development and testing environments in Marketing Cloud and establish an agreed process for moving changes between them.
2. Place Salesforce and Marketing Cloud assets under version control and establish a release process for deploying changes to production, with approval from Helen and Jennifer built into the process.
3. Map the Salesforce Core Critical paths and Marketing Cloud journeys and their dependencies, and write regression checks that can be automated later.
4. Measure technical debt using objective evidence and reduce it steadily.
5. Transition development from Viseo to the in-house team in stages while preserving in-flight projects and existing guarantees.
6. Day 90 measure: changes no longer begin in the live Marketing Cloud environment, at least one change has progressed through the new release process, and changes and new development are completed in-house.

Rollout

Week 1 to 4

Individual sessions with Helen, Jennifer, Anne and Scott: what works, what hurts, what they would change.

Attend as many requirements-gathering meetings in person as Helen and Jennifer consider necessary. Shadowing them will help me get to know the different stakeholders while becoming familiar with their working styles and requirements.

Establish obfuscation of personal identification information (PII) in testing environments, preferably by using Salesforce Data Mask or, alternatively, by writing an Apex script to ensure that customer data is protected.

Review the Salesforce contract and ask Salesforce to enable additional Marketing Cloud environments, including at least one testing environment and one development environment.

Review the current version-control system with Scott and create repositories for Salesforce Core and Salesforce Marketing Cloud.

Review with Scott the possibility of introducing an automated cybersecurity control, such as Snyk, for Salesforce Core, Salesforce Marketing Cloud and other company web pages during the development lifecycle.

Establish a learning plan to specialise in Salesforce Marketing Cloud Engagement, with a view to developing expertise in Marketing Cloud Next.

Review the areas in which Helen and Jennifer would like support to extend their knowledge, particularly those in which I have specialist expertise.

Create an inventory of the current pipeline assigned to Viseo and identify changes and new developments for which its services can be replaced.

Agree on a disengagement plan and deadline with Viseo.

Review with Jennifer the Salesforce Marketing Cloud SMS capability and establish an audience for Proof of Concept.

Establish a regular one-on-one meeting cadence with Anne to report progress, review deviations, and receive and act on feedback.

Commence on on-going changes and new features from week 1 starting with quick wins. Where applicable, transfer knowledge in programmatic development to Helen according to her interests.

Week 5 to 8

If not completed earlier, address PII in testing environments using the selected solution, taking into account the limitations of a custom solution compared with Salesforce Data Mask.

Prepare scripts to enable deployments to Salesforce Core using repository-based changes and Salesforce CLI.

Subject to the availability of a new Salesforce Marketing Cloud Business Unit, implement programmatic deployment from the repository. This will enable Jennifer to develop and test in a non-production environment while supporting deployment to and rollback in production.

Discuss incoming work items for Salesforce Core and Salesforce Marketing Cloud, and establish a development pipeline agreed with Helen, Jennifer and the relevant stakeholders. This includes hands-on work in Salesforce Marketing Cloud, supported by Salesforce documentation, Jennifer's experience and Salesforce Trailhead.

Reduce Viseo's pipeline to pending deliverables, hyper-care, and defect fixes covered by warranty.

Extend SMS capability according to findings during POC.

Adhere to upskilling plan in Salesforce Marketing Cloud with the objective of obtaining SFMC certificate within a reasonable and agreed period.

Week 9 to 13

Enable deployment automation and continuous integration and continuous delivery (CI/CD) by using the scripts developed in the previous phase to automate deployments to target environments.

Establish security governance by reviewing profiles and permission sets and assigning users accordingly.

Establish an agile cadence with regular stand-ups and retrospectives, supported by continuous improvement as a team value.

Support Jennifer on identifying and implementing SMS capability according to findings in previous phase POC

Complete or nearly complete Viseo's disengagement, with all development activities handed over to me and reviewed by Helen and Jennifer for quality assurance.

Identify opportunities for test automation to support regression testing during deployments. Implement cucumber/java framework for lightweight testing automation and testing reporting.

Agree on and establish a release cadence that reflects the team's capacity for requirements gathering, development and testing.

Prepare a draft plan for the next 90 days using an agile approach and ensuring traceability from development to production.

Begin formal preparation to obtain a Salesforce Marketing Cloud certification with a timeline of 4 to 8 weeks.